

M I S S I O N F O R C E

CyberStorm

by Jeff Gilbert

"From the moment you stepped off that shuttle you became the property of Unitech. You think that because you survived the Academy that I should be impressed. Here's a hard dose of reality: Unitech does not give a

damn about you. All Unitech cares about is the bottom line. Are you making us money, or are you costing us money? Prove to us that you can make Unitech more profitable without blowing yourself up and maybe we'll let you command more. If you screw up, we'll strand you on a barren moon somewhere with a beacon strapped around your neck guaranteed to attract every Cybrid in the sector."

Thus begins your fated journey into *Mission Force: CyberStorm*, the mind-blowing new strategy game from the creators of *Earthsiege* and *Earthsiege 2*. In *Mission Force*, the playing field is the universe and all that stands between you and Unitech victory are robotic Cybrids designed to recycle that army of tin cans you command. They're everywhere. They're waiting. And they're laughing. Your tools are synthetic Bioderms and a squadron of HERCS. Your only real weapon is your brain. You have to ask yourself one question: "Is today the day I bite the big one?"

"My first mission is mining ore on Mardalla. I've got two HERCS, a couple of Bioderms, and an entire month to complete the job. I wonder if they get cable on this planet?"

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INTERAction Magazine

As part of the new breed of PC strategy games released by Sierra, *Mission Force: CyberStorm* is poised to challenge the most accomplished gamer and those with chronic finger twitch from playing too many Doom clones. Yours is a fleet of up to 26 HERCS and genetically-engineered Bioderms to pilot

them. Select from a wide range of nerve-testing missions. Choose your battlefield and custom design your troops. Arm them with weapons. Lots of weapons. Next stop, the ore-rich fields of Mardalla, the Cybrid-occupied Brell, or the dreaded Parsus, with its toxic atmosphere. The enemy is already there. Engage. You lose, you die. That's the simple part. Taking strategy gaming to uncharted realms, Sierra reinvents the interactive experience and gives the player whole new worlds to destroy. Think of it as chess played in deep space. With plasma cannons.

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"What is it with these Bioderms? A little too much adrenaline and they think they're The Terminator. It's like they've got a mind of their own or something!"

One of the most fascinating aspects of *Mission Force: CyberStorm* is the introduction of Bioderms, human/machine hybrids who

pilot your HERCS into confrontations with The Enemy. You're given the option of purchasing specific HERCS prior to each mission. Some are fast. Some can carry more ore than others. Some can shoot the eyelids off a Cybrid

at twenty hexagons.

One of your goals is to not get them blown up. Unitech paid a lot for these hummers and will dock your pay the second one of them gets so much as a scratch. Next, it's up to you to custom manufacture a Bioderm to navigate your HERCS around hostile planet surfaces and even

more hostile Cybrids. The combination of HERC and Bioderm pairings are limitless. This is where your skill as a commander comes into play. Spend some quality time getting to know your Bioderms. You can even give them names like "Scruffy" or "Bob" or "Hairy Deathmeister the Third." Each syntho-human has an age, skill, rank, health, and stability rating. Warning: they have their own personality as well. Unitech calls them "Battle Glands." You'll call them "sir" if they become unpredictably aggressive after you've pumped

too much chemical adrenaline into their systems. If they don't turn on you, it's back to the Medvat for costly repairs. Being human means never having to say you're sorry.

"Dang it! Those pesky Cybrids are all over the place! Where are they coming from? Why are they shooting at me? Why are my Bioderms on fire?"

Like all wartime enemies the Cybrids are ruthless. They have outposts on every planet in the



Event animations draw you into the aggressive, territorial nature of Bioderm/HERC warfare.

solar system—including the ones Unitech keeps sending you to. And like your Bioderms, the Cybrids have someone—or something—controlling them, studying your every move and planning counterattacks. You might be able to defeat the Cybrids if you just had a few more credits to buy bigger and better weapons. But after that fiasco on Beran, you're a little light in the pocket. Until you excavate enough precious minerals you'll just have to

use your mind. What's left of it anyway. But why worry? With HERCS like Ogre, Giant, Reaper, and Juggernaut on your team, you've got this war in the bag. Right, Napoleon?



Engineer your own bioderms, then command them to do your bidding.

"Yesterday was ice and tundra. Today's planet is lava and brimstone. It's not

just the Cyrid onslaught getting to me these days, I also now know what to pack !"

Since *Mission Force: CyberStorm* randomly regenerates new terrains for each mission, you'll encounter multi-levels of ice, craters, cliffs, astro turf—maybe even grassy knolls and sandtraps. Keep your guard up because you never know what you'll step in. The game also gives you the option of viewing the battle arena from any number of perspectives.

Unfortunately, you can't see everything from above. So much for those new contacts. Zoom in for face-to-face combat. Zoom out to locate enemy bankheads. Rotate the map for precise targeting. Sounds easy? Yeah, right. Your



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—COMPUTER GAMING WORLD

HERCS

use up a lot of battery power maneuvering across the tricky terrain. The key here is strategy. It just wouldn't do to show up at a Cybrid's front door and not have the energy to knock, now would it? The shortest space between two HERCS is not always a straight line, so use your Unitech-trained cunning to plot every HERC move. Monitor their reactor levels. And for crying out loud, look out for that giant hole in the grou...

"Y'know, that mission wasn't so tough. I think Unitech underestimated my talents. Sure, I may be a lowly ensign now, but a few more breezy missions like this and they'll be calling me Admiral! Salute this, Unitech."

The difficulty factor of the missions offered vary to accommodate all skill levels of players, from Easy (wuss) to Normal (weenie), Hard (I'm working on it) to It's the End of the World as We Know It. *CyberStorm* is designed to accommodate a one-on-one bashfest of up to four players in full-on mortal cyborg combat. Match wits with the computer for single player action and enjoy a fair



A wide variety of missions assures that *MissionForce: CyberStorm* will challenge you for a good long time.

and just opponent. But war is hell. To get your hands really dirty, gamers can lock horns via modem, or better yet, a multi-player pig pile over a local area network. You want to show Unitech—and the world—you got what it takes, this is where you begin.

"As if I don't already have enough problems, a Cybrid just blew the arms off Kaeser, my favorite Bioderm. Where am I gonna find spare parts at this hour?"

CyberStorm's spectacular rotoscoped graphics allow the player to access and assess damage control options at a click of the mouse. Capt. Picard should have had it so easy. A spinning 3D wireframe depiction of your 'Derm is displayed with all of its mangled parts highlighted: structure, operating systems, weapons, internals. If you broke a nail, it'll show up here. Depending on your Unitech bank account you can repair your Bioderm as quickly as it is injured. (Just make sure the check doesn't bounce!) And don't overspend—you'll need to buy yourself a little retaliation. The first rule of combat: "If he can walk, he can fight." You'll find out what the second rule is soon enough.

"Oh, my aching porthole. I was ambushed from behind that pile of minerals. After I



You have total control over your fighting force. Build new Herces and bioderms to meet your needs.

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The SVGA graphics of this game are simply incredible.

came out of the Medvat, the last thing I remember thinking was "Wow! Look at all this ore! And no Cybrids anywhere in sight!"

Mission Force: CyberStorm has it all: incredibly easy and enthralling game play, face-melting graphics, liquid smooth action, terrifying monster robots, lasers, explosives, progressively

tough missions, an intuitive interface, and endless strategic variations. The Bionerms alone make *CyberStorm* unique. Where else are you going to find a computer game that lets its creations think for themselves? Click-'n-kick types will love the digital destruction. Silicone strategists will revel in well-planned offensives. Whether you want to flaunt your superior

intellect or make a Cybrid scream when it dies, *Mission Force: CyberStorm* is a new benchmark in hi-tech strategy gaming.

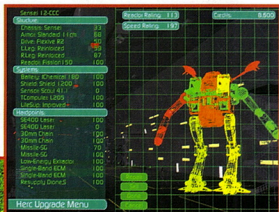
"Gee, if they weren't kicking my can all over the cosmos, I'd like to get to know those Cybrids a bit better. Maybe we could sit down over a couple cold mugs of Quatlooz and discuss some sort of truce?"

Mission Force: CyberStorm is a thoroughly addictive and formidable game. Don't worry, erratic Bionerms aside, the tougher it gets, the tougher you'll get, too. Your job is to put an end to Cybrid tyranny and those



Hex-based combat gives you the ability to double up on an enemy target and inflict serious hurt.

relentless storm-troopers of doom who want nothing more than to rid the universe of soft and weak, ore-hogging humans. Theirs is a code of no mercy. Extend them the same courtesy—blast their soundcards to smithereens. Oh, you'll suffer casualties. The best generals do. But don't let 'em see you flinch. Remember: in space, no one can hear you whine.



Go shopping to buy your HERCs a new set of weapons.



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